LUKAS J. GUNSCHERA

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EDUCATION

University of Cambridge – MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit — From Oct 2023
PhD, Medical Science — *Cambridge, UK*

University of Amsterdam — Sep 2020 – Sep 2022
Master of Science, Psychological Research (cum laude) — *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

Radboud University — Sep 2017 – Sep 2020
Bachelor of Science (Honours), Psychology (cum laude) — *Nijmegen, The Netherlands*

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

University of Cambridge – MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit — Oct 2022 – Oct 2023
Postgraduate Research Assistant (full time) — *Cambridge, UK*

Research spanning computational, longitudinal, psychopharmacological, and experimental approaches to probe the mechanisms of problematic social media use. *Supervision: Amy Orben.*

University of Oxford — Nov 2021 – Nov 2022
Research Assistant (part time) — *Oxford, UK*

Research on selective attention and learning deficits in psychopathic individuals and potential downstream consequences. *Supervision: Elaine Fox & Robin Murphy.*

University of Amsterdam — Sep 2021 – Oct 2022
Teaching Assistant (part time) — *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

University of Amsterdam — Feb 2021 – Dec 2022
Research Assistant (part time) — *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

Worked in multiple research groups and was involved in all aspects of the research process. Notable contributions include co-leading a large longitudinal collaboration. *Supervision: Bruno Verschuere & Sanne de Wit.*

VISITING POSITIONS AND PLACEMENTS

University of Rotterdam — Jun 2024
Visiting PhD Student — *Rotterdam, The Netherlands*

University of Oxford — Oct 2019 – Nov 2019
Visiting Researcher — *Oxford, UK*

Radboud University — Jan 2018 – Sep 2020
Honours Programme & Interdisciplinary Honours Programme — *Nijmegen, The Netherlands*

PUBLICATIONS

**** = shared senior authorship, * = equal contribution**

Turner, G., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Subrahmanya, S., Salecha, A., Eichstaedt, J.C., Palminteri, S., & Orben, A. (2026). A computational model of reward learning and habits on social media. *Nature Communications*. doi.org/10.1038/s41467-026-73547-6

Ferguson, A. M., Richards, M., **Gunschera, L. J.**, Mutak, A., Modecki, K., Goldberg, R. E., & Orben, A. (2026). Development and validation of a comprehensive digital parenting scale. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2026.101098

Gunschera, L.J., Dutton, K., Fox, E., Temple-McCune, A., & Murphy, R. (2024). Overburdening associations: The dependency of psychopathy-related acquisitional learning deficits on processing load. *Personality and Individual Differences.* doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2024.112705

Van der Cruyssen, I., Ben-Shakhar, G., Pertzov, Y., Guy, N., Cabooter, Q., **Gunschera, L.J.**, & Verschuere, B. (2024). The validation of online webcam-based eye-tracking: The replication of the cascade effect, the novelty

preference, and the visual world paradigm. *Behavior Research Methods.* doi.org/10.3758/s13428-023-02221-2

Gunschera, L.J., Verschuere, B., Murphy, R., Temple-McCune, A., Dutton, K., & Fox, E. (2023). No impaired integration in psychopathy: Evidence from an illusory conjunction paradigm. *Personality Disorders: Theory, Research, and Treatment*. doi.org/10.1037/per0000619.

Gunschera, L.J., Brazil, I.A., & Driessen, J.M.A. (2022). Social economic decision-making and psychopathy: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *Neuroscience & Biobehavioral Reviews.* 10.1016/j.neubiorev.2022.104966

UNDER REVIEW AND PREPRINTS

Gunschera, L.J., Adjallah, J., Fokas, I., Mackie, G., Hickman Dunne, J., Roe, A., Davies, J., Nord, C.**, Panayiotou, M.**, Orben, A.** (under review). Aligning how we measure and support social media addiction with young people's lived experience. *PsyArXiv.* doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/wahf5_v1

Gunschera, L.J.*, Orben, A.*, Fokas, I.*, … Purba, A.K.**, Orben, A.** (under review). Addressing the absence of robust causal evidence linking social media to population-level adolescent mental health declines.

Gunschera, L.J., Mehrhof, S.Z., Veith, C., Ong, E., Davidson, B.C., Vuorre, M., Nord, C.L.**, Orben, A.** (under review). Does social media use show established neurocognitive signatures of addiction? *PsyArXiv.* osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/2eqs8

Panayiotou, M., Banwell, E., Black, L., Hickman Dunne, J., Davies, J., Hamilton, S., Davidson, B., **Gunschera, L.J.** (under review). From motivation to experience: Rethinking the complex psychological processes of adolescent social media engagement.

Davidson, B.C., Turner, G., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Orben, A. (under review). Social media reward sensitivity and depressive symptoms over time. *PsyArXiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/8e3ar_v1

Davidson, B.C., Turner, G., Palminteri, S., Tomova, L., Eichstaedt, J.C., Salecha, A., Subrahmanya, S., Orben, A.**, **Gunschera, L.J.**** (under review). Prolonged social isolation is associated with increased behavioural sensitivity to 'likes' on social media. *PsyArXiv.* doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/65tdz_v1.

Turner, G., Valdez, C., **Gunschera, L.J.***, Anderson, I.*, Brufal, Z.*, Dillmann, S.*, Fassi, L.*, Monarca, I.*, Ramirez, O.P.*, Tentori, M., Orben, A. (under review). Relating smartphone 'app-journeys' to mental health: A novel network analysis approach. *PsyArXiv.* doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/uytfr_v1

Gunschera, L.J., Achterberg, M., Speyer, L.G., Wise, T., Orben, A. (under review). Towards identifying cognitive phenotypes of risk and resilience for social media and mental health. *PsyArXiv.* osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/bgqyj.

de Wit, S., Bieleke, M., Fletcher, P.C., Horstmann, A., Schueler, J., Brinkhof, L.P., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Murre, J.M.J. (under review). How long does it take to form a habit?: A multi-centre replication. *PCI Registered Reports Stage 1 acceptance*. https://rr.peercommunityin.org/PCIRegisteredReports/articles/rec?id=210

AWARDS AND TRAVEL FUNDING

UKRI Medical Research Council Studentship (£180,000)	Oct 2023 – Sep 2027
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Travel Grant (£280)	Sep 2026
Charles Slater Fund (£1,200)	Aug 2026
Guarantors of Brain, Travel Grant (£800)	Jul 2026
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Travel Grant (£500)	Apr 2026
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Travel Grant (£500)	May 2025
Wolfson College, Travel & Research Award (£400)	May 2025
British Association for Psychopharmacology, Bursary (£400)	May 2025
Wolfson College, Travel & Research Award (£400)	May 2024
American Psychological Association, Editor's Choice Award	Mar 2023
Thesis Award, Netherlands Institute of Psychologists (£400)	Mar 2023

TEACHING AND LECTURES

Open Science: A beginner's guide — From 2024
Cambridge Access to Mental Health & Psychology Programme — *Online*

Robust Statistics, Improving Scientific Practices From 2024
University of Cambridge, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit *Cambridge, UK*

Computational Reproducibility, Improving Scientific Practices From 2024
University of Cambridge, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit *Cambridge, UK*

PBS3 Social and Developmental Psychology 2024
University of Cambridge, Girton College *Cambridge, UK*

Meta-Analysis 2022
University of Amsterdam *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

Scientific Writing and Presenting 2022
University of Amsterdam *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

Addiction and Compulsive Disorders 2021
University of Amsterdam *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

SUPERVISION AND TRAINING RECORD

***Research Assistants and Interns* (6)**
Gerald Akuarista (University of Cambridge) From 2026
Jamil Adjallah (University of Cambridge) 2025 – 2026
Ioanna Fokas (University of Cambridge) 2024 – 2026
Brandon Davidson (University of Cambridge) 2024 – 2026
Emily Poort (University of Amsterdam) 2022
Gustaw Opielka (University of Amsterdam) 2022

***Graduate Students* (1)**
Clelia Veith (Technical University of Munich) 2025 – 2026

***Undergraduate Students* (3)**
Ruxandra Ursache (University of Cambridge) 2025 – 2026
James D'Silva (University of Cambridge) 2025 – 2026
Ethan Ong (University of Cambridge) 2024 – 2025

EVIDENCE FOR POLICY

Written Evidence
Davidson, B.C., Fassi, L., Fokas, I., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Orben, A., Turner, G. (2025). Neuroscience and digital childhoods inquiry. *UK Department for Science, Innovation and Technology.* https://committees.parliament.uk/writtenevidence/165731/default/

Orben, A., Purba, A.K., Fokas, I., **Gunschera, L.J.** et al. (2025). Feasibility Study of Methods and Data to Understand the Impact of Smartphones and Social Media on Children and Young People. *UK Department for Science, Innovation and Technology.* https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/understand-the-impact-of-smartphones-and-social-media-on-children-and-young-people/understand-the-impact-of-smartphones-and-social-media-on-children-and-young-people-executive-summary

Gunschera, L.J., Orben, A., Turner, G. (2024). Addressing Gaps in Digital Media Research: Pathways for Future Science and Policy. *European Joint Research Commission Report.* https://publications.jrc.ec.europa.eu/repository/handle/JRC143343

Orben, A., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Turner, G. (2023). Written evidence for Initiative to protect youth mental health, safety, and privacy online. *National Telecommunications and Information Administration.* NTIA-2023-0008-0001

Oral Evidence
Addressing gaps in digital media research: Pathways for future science and policy, European Commission, Mar 2025, *Online*

Roundtable on Call for Evidence on Researchers' access to information from regulated online services, Ofcom, Nov 2024, London, UK

INVITED TALKS AND SYMPOSIA

Problematic social media use in ADHD: A comparison on and off dopaminergic medication Aug 2026
Istanbul, Turkey
International Conference on Behavioural Addictions

Dopamine hits? Using methylphenidate to probe the mechanisms of problematic social media use — Jul 2026
British Association for Psychopharmacology Summer Meeting — *Birmingham, UK*

Does social media use show established neurocognitive signatures of addiction? — Jul 2026
Solitude lab seminar series — *Online*

Rethinking social media addiction: The importance of mechanisms of diagnosis and treatment — Jul 2026
Royal College of Psychiatrists: Faculty of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry annual conference — *Manchester, UK*

Adolescents in the wild web: bringing order to chaos through research — Sep 2025
Royal College of Psychiatrists: Faculty of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry Annual Conference (Symposium) — *Manchester, UK*

Cognitive phenotypes of risk and resilience for the relationship between social media and mental health — Sep 2024
Gillan Lab, Trinity College Dublin — *Online*

Cognitive processes linking social media and mental health — Sep 2024
CERES, Jacobs Foundation — *Newport Beach, USA*

Cognitive phenotypes of social media risk and resilience — Jun 2024
SO-REBEL and SYNC research groups, University of Rotterdam — *Rotterdam, The Netherlands*

A shared responsibility: Improving causal literacy across the scientific pipeline — Jun 2023
Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science (Workshop) — *Padova, Italy*

No impaired integration in psychopathy — Mar 2023
Personality disorder and addiction conference — *Utrecht, The Netherlands*

Do psychopaths suffer from impaired information integration? — Feb 2023
Netherlands Institute of Psychologists — *Online*

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Notes on Science — 2024 – 2026
Co-Founder — *Cambridge, UK*

Cambridge Access to Mental Health & Psychology Programme — 2024 – 2026
Supervisor & Lecturer — *Cambridge, UK*

Pint of Science — 2024
Organising Member — *Cambridge, UK*

Open Science Day MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit — Mar 2024
Co-Organiser — *Cambridge, UK*

Podcasts: The Naked Scientists: *Social media designed to be addictive, jury finds.* https://tidyurl.xyz/DHDA; Cognitations: *Social media and mental health: The cognitive turn.* https://tidyurl.xyz/YFsi.

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Open Science Committee, Chair — From 2025

MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Open Science Committee, Member — From 2022

Cambridge Journal of Science and Policy, Editor — 2023 – 2025

Student Initiative for Open Science, Member — 2021 – 2022

University of Amsterdam, Student Delegate — 2020 – 2022

Open Science: Data and code from all experiments (except where prohibited for sensitivity or legal reasons) are available at https://osf.io/user/4ysqz, https://zenodo.org, and https://github.com/lukasgunschera. Most studies are preregistered on the OSF or Prospero.

Journal Reviewer: Nature, Nature Human Behaviour, Comprehensive Psychiatry, Journal of Behavioral Addictions, Peer Community in Registered Reports, Royal Society Open Science, Motivation and Emotion, PLOS ONE

Society Membership: International Society for the Study of Behavioural Addictions (From 2026), Society for the Study of Addiction (From 2025), British Psychological Society (From 2025), British Association for Psychopharmacology (From 2024), Cambridge Philosophical Society (From 2023), Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science (2023–2024), Psychonomic Society (2022–2024), Society for Applied Research in Memory & Cognition (2022–2024)

SKILLS

Programming	R, Stan, Git, jsPsych, SQL, MPLUS, Python, Docker, Inquisit, Lotus
Data acquisition	Electroencephalography, electrodermal, electrocardiography, respiration, eye-tracking, ecological momentary assessment
Formal Analyses	Bayesian inference, computational modelling, multilevel modelling, longitudinal modelling, structural equation modelling, meta-analysis

For references, please contact:

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Professor Camilla Nord, Programme Leader, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit, University of Cambridge, camilla.nord[at]mrc-cbu.cam.ac.uk